

What other savings methods can I try?

It's completely understandable if the Pocket Money Savings Plan doesn't sound like the plan for you – it's a radical way to manage your finances, and relies on you finding the right financial gatekeeper. Here are some alternatives.

Say no to tap and go

Spending cash might just be the trick to saving.

The convenience of tap technology at the register might be the downfall of even the most dedicated saver, data suggests. I can attest to the numbing effect of swiping a piece of plastic to make a purchase, and unexpectedly running short at the end of a week. A quick mental tally will reveal what's to blame, and over time being tap-happy can lead to heartbreak for the first home saver.

Finance guru and *Domain* national business editor Chris Kohler writes, in an article called 'Tap, spend, forget: Why using cash could be the key to saving money', that if you're trying to save for a first home, you may want to think about stuffing your wallet with cash:

A thing called the 'cashless effect' is making us spend much, much more than we realise. And that has a big impact on the budget of a saver. Your overall spending on small and non-essential items could be 40 to 50 per cent higher if you use cards to pay instead of notes and coins.

Donnel Briley, professor of marketing and behavioural psychology at Sydney University, explains this phenomenon to Kohler: